

Activity 1 - Socratic Prompting:

Answer:

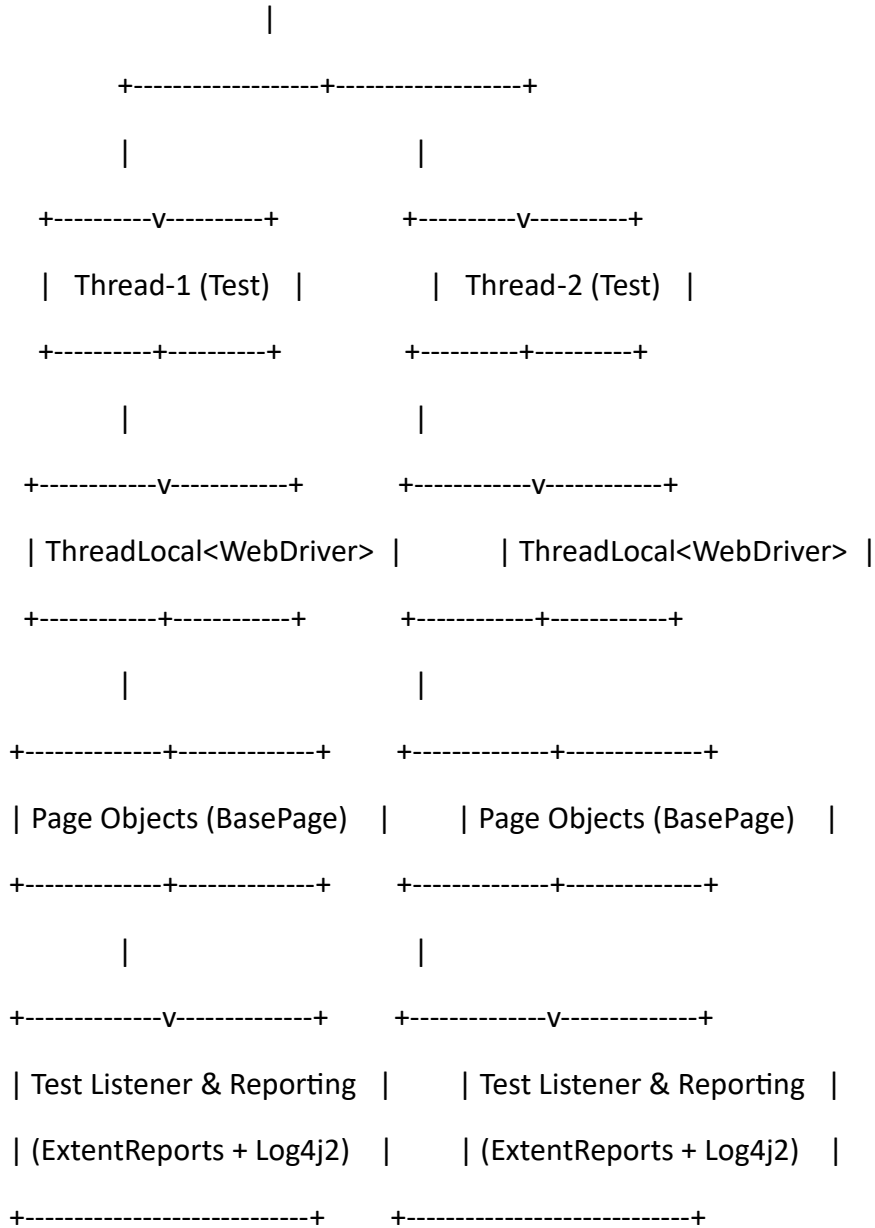
Below is the complete design blueprint and production-ready implementation for your scalable, data-driven Selenium framework.

1. Summary of Requirements

Requirement Area	Selected Choice	Strategy / Implementation Details
Data Management	Apache POI (.xlsx)	Test datasets driven by Excel spreadsheets using an Apache POI utility integrated with TestNG @DataProvider.
Driver & Execution	Local Parallel Execution	ThreadLocal<WebDriver> thread isolation, TestNG parallel execution (parallel="methods"), and Selenium 4 Manager for automatic driver bin management.
Reporting & Logging	ExtentReports + Log4j2	ExtentReports V5 for execution metrics and failure screenshots, paired with Log4j2 for console and rolling file logs.
Config Management	Multi-Environment .properties	Environment-aware property loading driven by -Denv (e.g., qa, dev) defaulting to qa.

2. Architecture & Design Decisions

	TestNG Suite Runner	
	(parallel = methods)	



* Thread-Safety & Isolation (ThreadLocal): Prevents cross-thread interference during parallel execution by giving each test thread its own isolated instance of WebDriver and ExtentTest.

* Page Object Model with Base Abstraction: All page classes extend a BasePage that encapsulates explicit waits (WebDriverWait), reducing boilerplate and flakiness.

* Decoupled Data Engine: Test logic remains clean while an ExcelUtil converts Excel tables into 2D arrays (Object[][]) consumed directly by TestNG @DataProvider.

* Listener-Driven Lifecycle Management: ExtentReports and Log4j2 hooks are managed through TestNG's ITestListener, keeping test classes free of reporting boilerplate.

3. Recommended Project Structure

selenium-automation-framework/

```
├── pom.xml
├── src/
│   ├── main/
│   │   ├── java/
│   │   │   ├── com/
│   │   │   │   ├── framework/
│   │   │   │   │   ├── config/
│   │   │   │   │   │   ├── ConfigReader.java
│   │   │   │   │   │   ├── driver/
│   │   │   │   │   │   │   ├── DriverFactory.java
│   │   │   │   │   │   │   ├── DriverManager.java
│   │   │   │   │   │   │   ├── utils/
│   │   │   │   │   │   │   │   ├── ExcelUtil.java
│   │   │   │   │   │   │   │   ├── ScreenshotUtil.java
│   │   │   │   │   │   │   │   ├── Log.java
│   │   │   │   │   │   │   ├── reports/
│   │   │   │   │   │   │   │   ├── ExtentManager.java
│   │   │   │   │   │   │   │   ├── ExtentTestManager.java
│   │   │   │   │   │   │   ├── pages/
│   │   │   │   │   │   │   │   ├── BasePage.java
│   │   │   │   │   │   │   │   ├── LoginPage.java
```

```

|   └─ test/
|       └─ java/
|           └─ com/
|               └─ framework/
|                   └─ listeners/
|                       └─ TestListener.java
|                           └─ tests/
|                               └─ BaseTest.java
|                                   └─ LoginTest.java
|   └─ resources/
|       └─ config/
|           └─ dev.properties
|               └─ qa.properties
|       └─ testdata/
|           └─ TestData.xlsx
|       └─ log4j2.xml
|       └─ testng.xml

```

4. Complete Implementation

4.1. pom.xml

```

<?xml version="1.0" encoding="UTF-8"?>

<project xmlns="http://maven.apache.org/POM/4.0.0"
    xmlns:xsi="http://www.w3.org/2001/XMLSchema-instance"
    xsi:schemaLocation="http://maven.apache.org/POM/4.0.0
        http://maven.apache.org/xsd/maven-4.0.0.xsd">

    <modelVersion>4.0.0</modelVersion>

```

<groupId>com.framework</groupId>

<artifactId>selenium-automation-framework</artifactId>

<version>1.0-SNAPSHOT</version>

<properties>

 <maven.compiler.source>17</maven.compiler.source>

 <maven.compiler.target>17</maven.compiler.target>

 <project.build.sourceEncoding>UTF-8</project.build.sourceEncoding>

 <selenium.version>4.23.0</selenium.version>

 <testng.version>7.10.2</testng.version>

 <poi.version>5.3.0</poi.version>

 <extent.version>5.1.2</extent.version>

 <log4j.version>2.23.1</log4j.version>

</properties>

<dependencies>

 <!-- Selenium Java -->

 <dependency>

 <groupId>org.seleniumhq.selenium</groupId>

 <artifactId>selenium-java</artifactId>

 <version>\${selenium.version}</version>

 </dependency>

 <!-- TestNG -->

 <dependency>

```
<groupId>org.testng</groupId>  
<artifactId>testng</artifactId>  
<version>${testng.version}</version>  
<scope>test</scope>  
</dependency>
```

```
<!-- Apache POI for Excel Parsing -->  
<dependency>  
  <groupId>org.apache.poi</groupId>  
  <artifactId>poi-ooxml</artifactId>  
  <version>${poi.version}</version>  
</dependency>
```

```
<!-- ExtentReports -->  
<dependency>  
  <groupId>com.aventstack</groupId>  
  <artifactId>extent-reports</artifactId>  
  <version>${extent.version}</version>  
</dependency>
```

```
<!-- Log4j2 -->  
<dependency>  
  <groupId>org.apache.logging.log4j</groupId>  
  <artifactId>log4j-api</artifactId>  
  <version>${log4j.version}</version>  
</dependency>
```

```
<dependency>
  <groupId>org.apache.logging.log4j</groupId>
  <artifactId>log4j-core</artifactId>
  <version>${log4j.version}</version>
</dependency>
</dependencies>

<build>
  <plugins>
    <plugin>
      <groupId>org.apache.maven.plugins</groupId>
      <artifactId>maven-surefire-plugin</artifactId>
      <version>3.3.1</version>
      <configuration>
        <suiteXmlFiles>
          <suiteXmlFile>src/test/resources/testng.xml</suiteXmlFile>
        </suiteXmlFiles>
      </configuration>
    </plugin>
  </plugins>
</build>
</project>
```

4.2. Configuration Management

src/test/resources/config/qa.properties

browser=chrome

baseUrl=https://opensource-demo.orangehrmlive.com

implicitWait=10

explicitWait=15

headless=false

src/test/resources/config/dev.properties

browser=firefox

baseUrl=https://dev-demo.orangehrmlive.com

implicitWait=5

explicitWait=10

headless=false

src/main/java/com/framework/config/ConfigReader.java

package com.framework.config;

import java.io.FileInputStream;

import java.io.IOException;

import java.util.Properties;

/**

* Singleton Configuration Reader dynamically loading target environment property files.

*/

public class ConfigReader {

private static Properties properties;

static {


```

// Default to 'qa' environment if -Env is not supplied
String env = System.getProperty("env", "qa").toLowerCase();
String configPath = "src/test/resources/config/" + env + ".properties";

try (FileInputStream fis = new FileInputStream(configPath)) {
    properties = new Properties();
    properties.load(fis);
} catch (IOException e) {
    throw new RuntimeException("Could not load configuration file at: " + configPath, e);
}

}

public static String getProperty(String key) {
    String value = properties.getProperty(key);
    if (value == null) {
        throw new RuntimeException("Property key '" + key + "' not found in configuration.");
    }
    return value;
}

public static int getIntProperty(String key) {
    return Integer.parseInt(getProperty(key));
}

public static boolean getBooleanProperty(String key) {
    return Boolean.parseBoolean(getProperty(key));
}

```

```
}  
}
```

4.3. Logging Configuration

src/test/resources/log4j2.xml

```
<?xml version="1.0" encoding="UTF-8"?>  
  
<Configuration status="WARN">  
  
  <Appenders>  
  
    <Console name="ConsoleAppender" target="SYSTEM_OUT">  
  
      <PatternLayout pattern="%d{yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm:ss.SSS} [%t] %-5level %logger{36} -  
%msg%n"/>  
  
    </Console>  
  
    <RollingFile name="FileAppender" fileName="logs/automation.log"  
  
      filePattern="logs/automation-%d{yyyy-MM-dd}-%i.log">  
  
        <PatternLayout pattern="%d{yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm:ss.SSS} [%t] %-5level %logger{36} -  
%msg%n"/>  
  
        <Policies>  
  
          <SizeBasedTriggeringPolicy size="10MB"/>  
  
        </Policies>  
  
      </RollingFile>  
  
    </Appenders>  
  
    <Loggers>  
  
      <Root level="info">  
  
        <AppenderRef ref="ConsoleAppender"/>  
  
        <AppenderRef ref="FileAppender"/>  
  
      </Root>  
  
    </Loggers>
```

</Configuration>

src/main/java/com/framework/utils/Log.java

package com.framework.utils;

import org.apache.logging.log4j.LogManager;

import org.apache.logging.log4j.Logger;

public class Log {

private static final Logger logger = LogManager.getLogger(Log.class);

public static void info(String message) {

logger.info(message);

}

public static void warn(String message) {

logger.warn(message);

}

public static void error(String message) {

logger.error(message);

}

public static void debug(String message) {

logger.debug(message);

}

```
}
```

4.4. Driver Management (ThreadLocal)

src/main/java/com/framework/driver/DriverManager.java

```
package com.framework.driver;
```

```
import org.openqa.selenium.WebDriver;
```

```
/**
```

```
 * Thread-safe wrapper around ThreadLocal<WebDriver>.
```

```
 */
```

```
public class DriverManager {
```

```
    private static final ThreadLocal<WebDriver> driverThreadLocal = new ThreadLocal<>();
```

```
    public static WebDriver getDriver() {
```

```
        return driverThreadLocal.get();
```

```
    }
```

```
    public static void setDriver(WebDriver driver) {
```

```
        driverThreadLocal.set(driver);
```

```
    }
```

```
    public static void unload() {
```

```
        driverThreadLocal.remove();
```

```
    }
```

```
}
```

```
src/main/java/com/framework/driver/DriverFactory.java
```

```
package com.framework.driver;
```

```
import com.framework.config.ConfigReader;
```

```
import org.openqa.selenium.WebDriver;
```

```
import org.openqa.selenium.chrome.ChromeDriver;
```

```
import org.openqa.selenium.chrome.ChromeOptions;
```

```
import org.openqa.selenium.edge.EdgeDriver;
```

```
import org.openqa.selenium.edge.EdgeOptions;
```

```
import org.openqa.selenium.firefox.FirefoxDriver;
```

```
import org.openqa.selenium.firefox.FirefoxOptions;
```

```
import java.time.Duration;
```

```
public class DriverFactory {
```

```
    public static WebDriver createDriver() {
```

```
        WebDriver driver;
```

```
        String browser = ConfigReader.getProperty("browser").toLowerCase();
```

```
        boolean isHeadless = ConfigReader.getBooleanProperty("headless");
```

```
        switch (browser) {
```

```
            case "chrome":
```

```
                ChromeOptions chromeOptions = new ChromeOptions();
```

```
                if (isHeadless) chromeOptions.addArguments("--headless=new");
```

```

        chromeOptions.addArguments("--start-maximized");
        driver = new ChromeDriver(chromeOptions);
        break;

    case "firefox":
        FirefoxOptions firefoxOptions = new FirefoxOptions();
        if (isHeadless) firefoxOptions.addArguments("-headless");
        driver = new FirefoxDriver(firefoxOptions);
        driver.manage().window().maximize();
        break;

    case "edge":
        EdgeOptions edgeOptions = new EdgeOptions();
        if (isHeadless) edgeOptions.addArguments("--headless=new");
        driver = new EdgeDriver(edgeOptions);
        driver.manage().window().maximize();
        break;

    default:
        throw new IllegalArgumentException("Unsupported browser: " + browser);
}

int implicitWait = ConfigReader.getIntProperty("implicitWait");
driver.manage().timeouts().implicitlyWait(Duration.ofSeconds(implicitWait));

return driver;

```

```
}  
}
```

4.5. Reporting & Utilities

src/main/java/com/framework/reports/ExtentManager.java

```
package com.framework.reports;
```

```
import com.aventstack.extentreports.ExtentReports;
```

```
import com.aventstack.extentreports.reporter.ExtentSparkReporter;
```

```
import com.aventstack.extentreports.reporter.configuration.Theme;
```

```
public class ExtentManager {
```

```
    private static ExtentReports extent;
```

```
    public static synchronized ExtentReports getInstance() {
```

```
        if (extent == null) {
```

```
            ExtentSparkReporter spark = new  
ExtentSparkReporter("build/reports/ExtentReport.html");
```

```
            spark.config().setReportName("Automation Test Results");
```

```
            spark.config().setDocumentTitle("Execution Report");
```

```
            spark.config().setTheme(Theme.STANDARD);
```

```
            extent = new ExtentReports();
```

```
            extent.attachReporter(spark);
```

```
            extent.setSystemInfo("Framework", "Selenium Java Data-Driven");
```

```
            extent.setSystemInfo("OS", System.getProperty("os.name"));
```

```
    }  
    return extent;  
}  
}
```

src/main/java/com/framework/reports/ExtentTestManager.java

```
package com.framework.reports;
```

```
import com.aventstack.extentreports.ExtentTest;
```

```
/**
```

```
 * Thread-safe ExtentTest container.
```

```
 */
```

```
public class ExtentTestManager {
```

```
    private static final ThreadLocal<ExtentTest> extentTestMap = new ThreadLocal<>();
```

```
    public static ExtentTest getTest() {
```

```
        return extentTestMap.get();
```

```
    }
```

```
    public static void setTest(ExtentTest test) {
```

```
        extentTestMap.set(test);
```

```
    }
```

```
    public static void unload() {
```

```
        extentTestMap.remove();
```



```
}  
}
```

src/main/java/com/framework/utils/ScreenshotUtil.java

```
package com.framework.utils;
```

```
import com.framework.driver.DriverManager;
```

```
import org.openqa.selenium.OutputType;
```

```
import org.openqa.selenium.TakesScreenshot;
```

```
public class ScreenshotUtil {
```

```
    /**
```

```
     * Captures screenshot as Base64 for clean ExtentReport inline embedding.
```

```
    */
```

```
    public static String getBase64Screenshot() {
```

```
        return ((TakesScreenshot)
```

```
        DriverManager.getDriver()).getScreenshotAs(OutputType.BASE64);
```

```
    }
```

```
}
```

src/main/java/com/framework/utils/ExcelUtil.java

```
package com.framework.utils;
```

```
import org.apache.poi.ss.usermodel.*;
```

```
import java.io.FileInputStream;
```

```
import java.io.IOException;
```

```
public class ExcelUtil {
```

```
    /**
```

```
     * Parses an Excel sheet and converts row data into a 2D Object array for TestNG DataProvider.
```

```
    */
```

```
    public static Object[][] getTestData(String filePath, String sheetName) {
```

```
        Object[][] data = null;
```

```
        try (FileInputStream fis = new FileInputStream(filePath);
```

```
            Workbook workbook = WorkbookFactory.create(fis)) {
```

```
            Sheet sheet = workbook.getSheet(sheetName);
```

```
            if (sheet == null) {
```

```
                throw new RuntimeException("Sheet '" + sheetName + "' not found in '" + filePath);
```

```
            }
```

```
            int rowCount = sheet.getLastRowNum();
```

```
            int colCount = sheet.getRow(0).getLastCellNum();
```

```
            data = new Object[rowCount][colCount];
```

```
            DataFormatter formatter = new DataFormatter();
```

```
            for (int i = 0; i < rowCount; i++) {
```

```

        Row row = sheet.getRow(i + 1); // Skip header row
        for (int j = 0; j < colCount; j++) {
            if (row == null) {
                data[i][j] = "";
            } else {
                Cell cell = row.getCell(j);
                data[i][j] = formatter.formatCellValue(cell);
            }
        }
    }

} catch (IOException e) {
    Log.error("Failed to read Excel data from path: " + filePath);
    throw new RuntimeException("Excel Read Exception: ", e);
}

return data;
}
}

```

4.6. Page Objects (BasePage & Sample Page)

src/main/java/com/framework/pages/BasePage.java

```
package com.framework.pages;
```

```
import com.framework.config.ConfigReader;
```

```
import com.framework.driver.DriverManager;
```

```
import com.framework.utils.Log;

import org.openqa.selenium.By;

import org.openqa.selenium.WebElement;

import org.openqa.selenium.support.ui.ExpectedConditions;

import org.openqa.selenium.support.ui.WebDriverWait;


import java.time.Duration;


public abstract class BasePage {

    protected WebDriverWait wait;


    public BasePage() {

        int explicitWait = ConfigReader.getIntProperty("explicitWait");

        this.wait = new WebDriverWait(DriverManager.getDriver(),
Duration.ofSeconds(explicitWait));

    }


    protected void click(By locator, String elementName) {

        WebElement element = wait.until(ExpectedConditions.elementToBeClickable(locator));

        element.click();

        Log.info("Clicked on element: " + elementName);

    }


    protected void sendKeys(By locator, String value, String elementName) {

        WebElement element = wait.until(ExpectedConditions.visibilityOfElementLocated(locator));

        element.clear();

    }

}
```

```
    element.sendKeys(value);  
    Log.info("Typed '" + value + "' into: " + elementName);  
}
```

```
protected String getText(By locator, String elementName) {  
    WebElement element = wait.until(ExpectedConditions.visibilityOfElementLocated(locator));  
    String text = element.getText();  
    Log.info("Retrieved text from " + elementName + ": " + text);  
    return text;  
}
```

```
protected boolean isDisplayed(By locator, String elementName) {  
    try {  
        boolean displayed =  
wait.until(ExpectedConditions.visibilityOfElementLocated(locator)).isDisplayed();  
        Log.info("Visibility check for " + elementName + ": " + displayed);  
        return displayed;  
    } catch (Exception e) {  
        Log.warn("Element not visible: " + elementName);  
        return false;  
    }  
}  
}
```

src/main/java/com/framework/pages/LoginPage.java

```
package com.framework.pages;
```

```
import org.openqa.selenium.By;

public class LoginPage extends BasePage {

    // Locators using By strategy for better thread safety and dynamic waits
    private final By txtUsername = By.name("username");
    private final By txtPassword = By.name("password");
    private final By btnLogin = By.xpath("//button[@type='submit']");
    private final By txtDashboardHeader = By.xpath("//h6[text()='Dashboard']");
    private final By txtErrorMessage = By.xpath("//p[contains(@class, 'alert-content-text')]");

    public LoginPage enterUsername(String username) {
        sendKeys(txtUsername, username, "Username Field");
        return this;
    }

    public LoginPage enterPassword(String password) {
        sendKeys(txtPassword, password, "Password Field");
        return this;
    }

    public LoginPage clickLogin() {
        click(btnLogin, "Login Button");
        return this;
    }
}
```

```

public boolean isDashboardDisplayed() {
    return isDisplayed(txtDashboardHeader, "Dashboard Header");
}

public String getErrorMessage() {
    return getText(txtErrorMessage, "Error Message");
}
}

```

4.7. Test Framework & Listeners

src/test/java/com/framework/listeners/TestListener.java

```
package com.framework.listeners;
```

```

import com.aventstack.extentreports.ExtentTest;
import com.aventstack.extentreports.MediaEntityBuilder;
import com.aventstack.extentreports.Status;
import com.framework.reports.ExtentManager;
import com.framework.reports.ExtentTestManager;
import com.framework.utils.Log;
import com.framework.utils.ScreenshotUtil;
import org.testng.ITestContext;
import org.testng.ITestListener;
import org.testng.ITestResult;

```

```
public class TestListener implements ITestListener {
```

@Override

```
public void onStart(ITestContext context) {  
    Log.info("=== Starting Test Suite Execution: " + context.getName() + " ===");  
}
```

@Override

```
public void onFinish(ITestContext context) {  
    Log.info("=== Finished Test Suite Execution: " + context.getName() + " ===");  
    ExtentManager.getInstance().flush();  
}
```

@Override

```
public void onTestStart(ITestResult result) {  
    Log.info("Starting Test: " + result.getMethod().getMethodName());  
    ExtentTest test =  
ExtentManager.getInstance().createTest(result.getMethod().getMethodName());  
    ExtentTestManager.setTest(test);  
}
```

@Override

```
public void onTestSuccess(ITestResult result) {  
    Log.info("Test PASSED: " + result.getMethod().getMethodName());  
    ExtentTestManager.getTest().log(Status.PASS, "Test Executed Successfully");  
    ExtentTestManager.unload();  
}
```


@Override

```
public void onTestFailure(ITestResult result) {  
    Log.error("Test FAILED: " + result.getMethod().getMethodName());  
    Log.error(result.getThrowable().getMessage());  
  
    String base64Screenshot = ScreenshotUtil.getBase64Screenshot();  
  
    ExtentTestManager.getTest().log(  
        Status.FAIL,  
        result.getThrowable(),  
        MediaEntityBuilder.createScreenCaptureFromBase64String(base64Screenshot).build()  
    );  
    ExtentTestManager.unload();  
}
```

@Override

```
public void onTestSkipped(ITestResult result) {  
    Log.warn("Test SKIPPED: " + result.getMethod().getMethodName());  
    ExtentTestManager.getTest().log(Status.SKIP, "Test Skipped: " + result.getThrowable());  
    ExtentTestManager.unload();  
}  
}
```

src/test/java/com/framework/tests/BaseTest.java

package com.framework.tests;

```
import com.framework.config.ConfigReader;
import com.framework.driver.DriverFactory;
import com.framework.driver.DriverManager;
import com.framework.utils.Log;
import org.openqa.selenium.WebDriver;
import org.testng.annotations.AfterMethod;
import org.testng.annotations.BeforeMethod;
```

```
public abstract class BaseTest {
```

```
    @BeforeMethod
```

```
    public void setUp() {
```

```
        WebDriver driver = DriverFactory.createDriver();
```

```
        DriverManager.setDriver(driver);
```

```
        Log.info("Driver initialized on Thread ID: " + Thread.currentThread().getId());
```

```
        String baseUrl = ConfigReader.getProperty("baseUrl");
```

```
        DriverManager.getDriver().get(baseUrl);
```

```
        Log.info("Navigated to: " + baseUrl);
```

```
    }
```

```
    @AfterMethod
```

```
    public void tearDown() {
```

```
        if (DriverManager.getDriver() != null) {
```

```
            DriverManager.getDriver().quit();
```

```
        Log.info("Driver closed on Thread ID: " + Thread.currentThread().getId());  
        DriverManager.unload();  
    }  
}  
}
```

src/test/java/com/framework/tests/LoginTest.java

```
package com.framework.tests;
```

```
import com.framework.pages.LoginPage;
```

```
import com.framework.utils.ExcelUtil;
```

```
import org.testng.Assert;
```

```
import org.testng.annotations.DataProvider;
```

```
import org.testng.annotations.Test;
```

```
public class LoginTest extends BaseTest {
```

```
    @DataProvider(name = "excelData", parallel = false)
```

```
    public Object[][] getLoginData() {
```

```
        String excelPath = "src/test/resources/testdata/TestData.xlsx";
```

```
        return ExcelUtil.getTestData(excelPath, "LoginData");
```

```
    }
```

```
    @Test(dataProvider = "excelData")
```

```
    public void testDataDrivenLogin(String username, String password, String expectedResult) {
```

```
        LoginPage loginPage = new LoginPage();
```

```

loginPage.enterUsername(username)

        .enterPassword(password)

        .clickLogin();

if (expectedResult.equalsIgnoreCase("Success")) {

    Assert.assertTrue(loginPage.isDashboardDisplayed(), "Dashboard was expected but not
displayed.");

} else {

    Assert.assertTrue(loginPage.getErrorMessage().contains("Invalid"), "Expected error
message not displayed.");

}

}

}

```

4.8. Suite Execution Runner

src/test/resources/testng.xml

```

<?xml version="1.0" encoding="UTF-8"?>

<!DOCTYPE suite SYSTEM "https://testng.org/testng-1.0.dtd">

<suite name="Data Driven Automation Suite" parallel="methods" thread-count="3">

    <listeners>

        <listener class-name="com.framework.listeners.TestListener"/>

    </listeners>

    <test name="Login Tests">

        <classes>

            <class name="com.framework.tests.LoginTest"/>

```

```
</classes>

</test>

</suite>
```

5. Design Choice Analysis & Alternatives

1. ThreadLocal<WebDriver> vs. Static Driver Instances

Why this choice: Using a single public static WebDriver driver causes race conditions in multi-threaded executions. ThreadLocal wraps every driver instance into a dedicated memory bucket mapped to the executing thread, enabling safe parallel execution.

Alternative: Dependency Injection (e.g., Guice or Spring Test) passing WebDriver around via constructors. While clean, it adds dependency weight; ThreadLocal achieves isolation natively with minimal overhead.

2. Standard By Locators vs. @FindBy PageFactory

Why this choice: PageFactory initialized via PageFactory.initElements() caches elements or relies on implicit waits, which can lead to StaleElementReferenceException when combined with modern dynamic SPA (Single Page Application) frameworks. Using explicit waits on raw By locators ensures fresh DOM queries every time an interaction occurs.

Alternative: Fluent Page Object Model with @FindBy. Operates well for simple apps, but struggles under fast-changing DOM states compared to explicit WebDriverWait.

3. Base64 Screenshots vs. Local PNG File Storage

Why this choice: Saving screenshots as Base64 strings enables ExtentReports to embed images directly into a single self-contained .html report file. This simplifies report sharing across CI/CD pipelines and team channels without dealing with broken image links.

Alternative: Saving .png files to disk and embedding relative file paths. While this saves memory on massive runs, it breaks if the HTML file is emailed or moved without its image folder.

6. How to Run the Framework

1. Place your Excel sheet at src/test/resources/testdata/TestData.xlsx with a sheet named LoginData structured like:

Username	Password	ExpectedResult
Admin	admin123	Success
InvalidUser	wrongPass	Fail

2. Execute default (QA) suite via Maven:

Bash

```
mvn clean test
```

3. Execute against Dev environment with system property override:

Bash

```
mvn clean test -Denv=dev
```

4. View Execution Reports:

Open build/reports/ExtentReport.html in your browser.

Activity 2 - Chain of Thought (CoT)

Here is the systematic Chain of Thought (CoT) reasoning process used to investigate and uncover the root causes behind the generic error: "Transaction could not be completed."

"Chain of Thought (CoT) Investigation

Step 1: Define the Transaction Lifecycle

To diagnose why a ₹50,000 transfer failed, we must trace the request path:

Customer/App > Auth/Security > Network/Switch > Core Banking System > Beneficiary Account

Every layer in this workflow introduces potential points of failure.

Step 2: Examine Account & Balance Constraints (Remitter Side)

Thought: Before sending the request out to the bank servers, the system evaluates the sender's account state and transfer capability for ₹50,000.

Question: Does the user have the money, and are they allowed to send this amount today?

Scenario A: The account balance is less than ₹50,000 (e.g., balance is ₹35,000).

💡 Discovery Uncovered: Insufficient balance

Scenario B: The user has enough money, but they have already transferred their maximum permitted daily threshold (e.g., daily limit is ₹1,000,000, but ₹960,000 was spent earlier).

💡 Discovery Uncovered: Daily limit exceeded

Step 3: Examine Authentication & Authorization Layer

Thought: High-value transactions (₹50,000) require Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) via OTP or T-PIN.

Question: Was authorization completed successfully within the required timeframe?

Observation: If the user took too long to enter the One-Time Password sent to their mobile, or entered a delayed payload, the validation token becomes invalid.

💡 Discovery Uncovered: OTP expired

Step 4: Examine Fraud & Security Engines

Thought: Banking platforms pass high-value transfers through automated risk engines before processing.

Question: Did the ₹50,000 transfer trigger security anomalies?

Observation: Factors like a new device login, unusual location/IP, rapid sequential transfers, or a newly added beneficiary within the 24-hour cooling window can flag the transaction as high risk.

💡 Discovery Uncovered: Fraud rule triggered

Step 5: Examine Network & Transport Mechanics

Thought: The app issues an API request across the public cellular/Wi-Fi network to the bank's gateway.

Question: Did the request payload reach the destination and receive a response in time?

Observation: Poor network signal or high latency causes the connection to drop mid-flight or time out before the client gets a HTTP 200/ACK response.

💡 Discovery Uncovered: Network timeout

Step 6: Examine Payment Middleware & Switch Infrastructure

Thought: In India (indicated by ₹ symbol), ₹50,000 transfers typically route through payment switches like UPI, IMPS, or NEFT.

Question: Is the central routing switch operational?

Observation: If the NPCI UPI switch or the underlying bank payment gateway switch experiences heavy traffic or service failure, routing fails instantly.

💡 Discovery Uncovered: UPI switch unavailable

Step 7: Examine Bank Server & Core Banking Infrastructure (CBS)

Thought: Assuming the switch routed the request, the bank's internal servers must process the double-entry accounting ledger.

Question: Are the bank's API servers and backend databases online?

Scenario A: The bank's external API application servers are offline or unresponsive.

💡 Discovery Uncovered: Bank server unavailable

Scenario B: The centralized Core Banking System (CBS) database handling ledger updates is undergoing scheduled maintenance or experiencing a database crash.

💡 Discovery Uncovered: Core banking unavailable

Step 8: Examine Beneficiary (Receiving Account) State

Thought: The remitter's side and payment pipe cleared successfully, but the money needs to land in the target account.

Question: Can the destination account accept ₹50,000?

Observation: If the target account is dormant, frozen by regulatory orders, blocked due to uncompleted KYC, or closed, the transaction gets rejected by the receiving node.

💡 Discovery Uncovered: Beneficiary inactive

Summary of Discoveries

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Phase	Technical Layer	Root Cause Discovered	
+-----+-----+-----+			
1	Sender Account	1. Daily limit exceeded	
		2. Insufficient balance	
+-----+-----+-----+			
2	Auth & Security	3. OTP expired	
		4. Fraud rule triggered	
+-----+-----+-----+			
3	Transport & Network	5. Network timeout	
+-----+-----+-----+			
4	Middleware / Routing	6. UPI switch unavailable	
+-----+-----+-----+			
5	Bank Backend	7. Bank server unavailable	
		8. Core banking unavailable	
+-----+-----+-----+			

| 6 | Receiver Side | 9. Beneficiary inactive |

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1. Scenario Name : Scenario 1 — Search Functionality

Weak Prompt : "Test the search feature."

What I Feel is Missing:

1. Search Engine: Which backend service or product should power the search?
2. UI Component: Should the search be rendered as a persistent text box or a search icon?
3. Placement: Where should the search element be positioned in the UI?
4. Input Constraints: What are the accepted inputs (alphanumeric, special characters) and case-sensitivity rules?
5. Search Logic: Should the query execute an exact match or a partial ("contains") match?

 Rewritten Prompt

Persona: Act as Senior QA Engineer

Context: Use the Amazon website from India.

Instruction: Generate test case for UI search feature

[Critical] Where the Search box is positioned, Use alphanumeric, special characters during the search, whether the search result returns exact or partial match results.

[Mandatory] Search the books and educational toys for 3 years old kid with less than 1000 rupees.

[Strict] Generate 10 test case to cover all of the above features.

Example: Test ID | Description | Test Data | Pre-Condition | Steps | Expected Result

TC01 | Verify Search feature | Laptop | Amazon.in should login | 1. Login to Amazon.in | Login should successful

Output Format: Generate test cases to paste the table in Notepad++

Tone: It should meet the QA standard and should be simple & professional

Weak prompt Output:

Search Functionality

"Test the search feature."

Test Status: Passed 

The live web search integration is functional and returning current results.

Test Query Executed

Query: latest tech news August 2026

Status: 200 OK (Data retrieved successfully)

Sample Search Results

OpenAI / AI Updates: Reporting on OpenAI's Astra model, GPT-5.5 releases, and security safety pauses.

Emerging Tech Trends: World Economic Forum highlights including everything-to-grid energy and direct lithium extraction.

The World Economic Forum

Open-Source & Wikimedia: Tech updates regarding client-side rendering and category sorting features.

Diff - Wikimedia

ICEPOT Output:

Here is the test suite containing 10 comprehensive test cases designed to QA standards for the Amazon India (Amazon.in) search feature.

Test ID	Description	Test Data	
Pre-Condition	Steps		
Expected Result			

TC01	Verify UI positioning and visibility of the Search box across main pages		
N/A	Amazon.in homepage is loaded		1.
Open Amazon.in homepage.		Search box is	
prominently positioned at the top header center across all pages, with category dropdown on the left and			
		2. Verify the location of the search input box.	
search button on the right.			
		3. Navigate to a category page and a product detail page.	

TC02	Verify search functionality using alphanumeric characters		
"Lego classic 10696"		Amazon.in homepage is loaded	
1. Enter "Lego classic 10696" in the search box.			Search

results page loads successfully displaying Lego sets matching model number 10696.

|

| |

|

| | 2. Click the Search icon or press Enter.

|

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| TC03 | Verify search handling when input contains special characters |

"C# programming book & guide @2026!" | Amazon.in

homepage is loaded | 1. Enter special character string in search box.

| System handles special characters gracefully without application errors or blank screens,
returning relevant C# books. |

| |

|

| | 2. Click Search button. |

|

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| TC04 | Verify Exact Match search result accuracy | "The Very
Hungry Caterpillar board book" | Amazon.in homepage is loaded

| 1. Enter exact book title in the search box. | The exact

matching title "The Very Hungry Caterpillar" appears at the top position of the search results
page. |

| |

|

| | 2. Click Search icon. |

|

| |

|

| | 3. Inspect the top search result.

|

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| TC05 | Verify Partial Match search result accuracy | "wooden
toy train" | Amazon.in homepage is loaded | 1.
Enter partial product keywords in search box. | Search
results show items matching any or all keywords ("wooden", "toy", "train") with high relevance
ranking. |

| | |
| | 2. Click Search icon. |
|

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| TC06 | Verify search for Books for 3-year-old kids priced under ₹1000 |
Search Query: "story books for 3 year old kids", Filter: Under ₹1,000 | Amazon.in
homepage is loaded | 1. Select "Books" in category dropdown.
| Displayed books are strictly age-appropriate for 3-year-olds with prices equal to or less than
₹1,000. |

| | |
| | 2. Enter "story books for 3 year old kids" and search.
| |

| | |
| | 3. Apply Price Filter "Under ₹1,000" from left panel.
| |

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| TC07 | Verify search for Educational Toys for 3-year-old kids priced under ₹1000
| Search Query: "educational toys for 3 year old kids", Price Filter: Max ₹1000 |
Amazon.in homepage is loaded | 1. Type "educational toys for 3 year old kids under 1000" in
search bar. | Search results display educational toys (puzzles, building
blocks, learning sets) suited for 3-year-olds with prices under |

	2. Press Enter.	
₹1,000.		
	3. Check price filter in left navigation rail.	
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| TC08 | Verify category pre-selection combined with age and price constraints
| Category: Toys & Games, Search Term: "learning toys 3 years", Filter: Up to ₹1000 |
Amazon.in homepage is loaded | 1. Select "Toys & Games" from category dropdown.
| System filters out non-toy categories and shows 3-year learning toys costing ≤ ₹1,000.
|

	2. Search for "learning toys 3 years".	
	3. Select "Up to ₹1,000" under Price filter.	
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| TC09 | Verify search query combining Alphanumeric text, Special Characters, and Price/Age terms
| "3+ yr old kid's learning toy & puzzle <1000" |
Amazon.in homepage is loaded | 1. Enter complex combination query containing symbols (+, ', &, <) and numbers in search box. | Search query executes without script errors and returns relevant learning/puzzle toys targeted at 3+ year olds under ₹1,000. |

	2. Click Search.	

TC10	Verify Search box persistence, clearing, and re-querying capability	
"puzzle toys for 3 year old"	Search executed on	
Amazon.in	1. Perform search.	Query string persists in search box on results page, clear button resets input field instantly, and new suggestions appear

	2. Check if search term remains in search box.	
	when typing.	
	3. Click 'X' (clear) button in search box.	
	4. Enter new query.	

Key Coverage Summary

- * UI Positioning (TC01): Header search bar layout verification across page views.
- * Input Types (TC02, TC03, TC09): Alphanumeric, special characters (#, @, &, +, <), and mixed syntax.
- * Matching Precision (TC04, TC05): Exact product title matches vs keyword partial matches.
- * Business Mandatory Scenarios (TC06, TC07, TC08): Age-specific (3 years old) books and educational toys priced under ₹1,000 using search queries and facet filters.

Here is a direct side-by-side comparison of how your Input 1 (Vague) vs. Input 2 (Detailed Prompt Engineering) transformed the AI's understanding and generated output.

Side-by-Side Prompt & Output Comparison

Comparison	AxisInput 1: Bare RequestInput 2: Structured Prompting
Prompt Text	Search Functionality "Test the search feature." Persona: Senior QA EngineerContext: Amazon.inInstructions: [Critical], [Mandatory], [Strict] rulesExample Schema & Format: Defined
Prompt Technique	Zero-Context / Undefined Intent: No role, no target system, no format, no constraints. Role-Task-Context (RTC) Framework: Uses explicit Persona, domain constraints, priority tags, and output formatting.
AI Interpretation	Interpreted literally as: "Test whether AI search functionality works right now." Interpreted as: "Write a professional 10-case QA test suite for Amazon India's UI search bar."
Generated Output	Executed a web search query and returned a system test status report. Generated a 10-row structured QA test suite with realistic test data, exact matches, price filters (₹1,000), and special characters.
Usability	Unusable for a software testing workflow. Ready to paste directly into Notepad++, Excel, or TestRail.

2. Scenario Name : Scenario 2 — File Upload

Weak Prompt : "Generate test cases for file upload."

What I Feel is Missing:

1. Where to upload the file?
2. What are the file formats will it accept like PDF, TIF, TXT, DOCX, XSLX, HTM?
3. What is the maximum file size?
4. Will it accept the compressed files like zip, 7z?
5. Will the file names accept the long names with special charaters?

 Rewritten Prompt

Persona: Act as Senior QA Engineer

Context: Use the ilovepdf site to upload the files.

Instruction: Generate test case for file upload feature

[Critical] Where the upload file icon is positioned, Upload the files and if it is uploaded successfully then the success message should display and error should display if file size exceed or incorrect formats or very long file names.

[Mandatory] Include the following file formats PDF, TIF, TXT, DOCX, XSLX, HTM.

[Important] File size should not exceed greater than 5 MB.

It should not accept the compressed files.

It should not allow the very long file names like more than 55 characters.

It should allow the special characters in the file names.

[Strict] Generate 15 test case to cover positive, negative, edge and boundary.

Example: Test ID	Description	Test Data	Pre-Condition	Steps	Expected Result
------------------	-------------	-----------	---------------	-------	-----------------

TC01	Verify Search feature	Laptop	Amazon.in should login	1. Login to Amazon.in	Login should successful
------	-----------------------	--------	------------------------	-----------------------	-------------------------

Output Format: Generate test cases in ASCII grid table format to paste the table in Notepad++.

Tone: It should be in simple and formal.

Weak prompt Output:

Here's a comprehensive set of test cases for File Upload functionality, covering positive, negative, validation, security, UI, and performance scenarios.

TC ID	Test Case	Steps / Input	Expected Result	Priority
TC-01	Upload valid file successfully	Upload a supported file with valid size	File uploads successfully	High
TC-02	Upload multiple valid files successfully if multiple uploads are supported	Select multiple supported files	All files upload successfully	High
TC-03	Upload unsupported file type	Upload .exe / unsupported extension	Upload is rejected with appropriate error	High
TC-04	Upload maximum allowed file size successfully	Upload file exactly at size limit	File uploads successfully	High
TC-05	Exceed maximum file size with clear error message	Upload file larger than allowed limit	Upload is rejected with clear error message	High
TC-06	Upload empty/0-byte file	Upload a 0-byte file	System handles it according to requirements; appropriate validation shown	Medium
TC-07	Upload file with special characters	Use filename such as test@#\$.pdf	File is handled safely and uploaded/renamed as expected	Medium
TC-08	Upload file with spaces	Upload My Test File.pdf	File uploads successfully and filename is preserved correctly	Medium
TC-09	Upload duplicate file	Upload the same file twice	System handles duplicates according to requirements	Medium

TC-10	Cancel file selection	Select a file, then cancel the file picker	No file is uploaded or selected	Medium
TC-11	Remove selected file	Select a file and click Remove/Delete	File is removed from the upload list	High
TC-12	Replace uploaded file	Upload file, then select another file	Previous file is replaced if replacement is supported	Medium
TC-13	Upload without selecting file	Click Upload/Submit without a file	Appropriate validation message is displayed if file is mandatory	High
TC-14	Upload corrupted file	Upload a corrupted PDF/image/document	System rejects it or handles it gracefully	Medium
TC-15	Upload wrong MIME type	Rename an unsupported file with a supported extension	Server validates actual file type and rejects it if invalid	High
TC-16	Upload file with long filename	Use filename exceeding supported length	Filename is validated/truncated appropriately; upload does not break UI	Medium
TC-17	Upload Unicode filename	Upload résumé_日本語.pdf	File uploads and filename is handled correctly	Medium
TC-18	Upload file with uppercase extension	Upload TEST.PDF	File is accepted if extension is supported	Low
TC-19	Upload valid image	Upload supported JPG/PNG image	Image uploads successfully and preview appears if supported	High
TC-20	Upload invalid image	Upload unsupported image format	Appropriate validation error is displayed	Medium
TC-21	Upload via drag and drop	Drag a valid file into upload area	File is selected/uploaded successfully	High
TC-22	Drag unsupported file	Drag an unsupported file into upload area	File is rejected with appropriate message	Medium
TC-23	Verify upload progress	Upload a relatively large valid file	Progress indicator is displayed accurately	Medium
TC-24	Network interruption	Disconnect network during upload	Upload fails gracefully and user receives an appropriate message	High

TC-25	Retry failed upload successfully if supported	Cause upload failure and click Retry	Upload resumes/restarts	Medium
TC-26	Refresh during upload incomplete upload without corruption	Refresh page while upload is in progress	System handles	Medium
TC-27	Session timeout during upload is rejected safely and user is prompted appropriately	Allow session to expire during upload	Upload	High
TC-28	Verify uploaded file matches the original file	Upload file and download/open it afterward	Retrieved file	High
TC-29	Verify file metadata accurate	Upload file and inspect displayed name/size/type	Metadata is	Medium
TC-30	Security: executable upload according to security policy	Attempt to upload executable content	File is blocked	Critical
TC-31	Security: malicious filename as ../../file.pdf	Upload filename containing path traversal characters such as Path is sanitized; arbitrary filesystem access is impossible		Critical
TC-32	Security: malicious content	Upload a file containing potentially malicious content	File is scanned/rejected according to security requirements	Critical
TC-33	Authentication check authentication is required	Attempt upload without authentication	Upload is denied if	Critical
TC-34	Authorization check	User without upload permission attempts upload	Upload is denied	Critical
TC-35	Concurrent uploads correctly without data corruption	Upload several files simultaneously	System processes uploads	High
TC-36	Maximum number of files	Upload more files than the allowed count	Additional files are rejected with clear message	High
TC-37	File type validation message types	Upload invalid extension	Error identifies allowed file	Medium
TC-38	File size validation message size	Upload oversized file	Error identifies maximum allowed	Medium
TC-39	Browser compatibility across supported browsers	Test upload in supported browsers	Upload works consistently	Medium

TC-40 Mobile upload Upload using mobile browser/device File selection/camera/gallery integration works as expected Medium

TC-41 UI during upload Start upload and inspect controls Buttons/status indicators behave correctly and prevent unintended duplicate submissions Medium

TC-42 Upload button state Select invalid/valid files Upload button is enabled/disabled according to validation rules Medium

TC-43 Accessibility Navigate upload control using keyboard File upload can be operated using keyboard/accessibility controls Medium

TC-44 Screen reader support Use screen reader with upload control Labels, errors, progress, and status are announced appropriately Medium

TC-45 Server-side validation Bypass client-side validation and send invalid file directly Server still validates file type, size, permissions, etc. Critical

ICEPOT Output:

Below are 15 file-upload test cases for the iLovePDF site, written from a Senior QA Engineer perspective. The cases cover positive, negative, edge, and boundary conditions based on your specified requirements. iLovePDF supports file selection through the upload area and also supports drag-and-drop.

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-----+-----+-----+-----+				
Test ID	Description	Test Data	Pre-Condition	Steps
Expected Result		Type		
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+				
-----+-----+-----+-----+				
TC01	Verify upload file icon/area	Valid PDF file	iLovePDF page opened	1. Open
iLovePDF upload page	Upload file icon/area should be clearly visible	Positive		

		is displayed				2. Locate upload icon/area	
and positioned correctly for file selection.							

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	TC02		Upload valid PDF file		test.pdf, 4 MB		Upload area visible		1. Click
upload/select file			PDF file should upload successfully and success					Positive	

					2. Select test.pdf		message
should be displayed.							

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	TC03		Upload valid TIF file		test.tif, 4 MB		Upload area visible		1. Click
upload/select file			TIF file should upload successfully and success					Positive	

					2. Select test.tif		message
should be displayed.							

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	TC04		Upload valid TXT file		test.txt, 4 MB		Upload area visible		1. Click
upload/select file			TXT file should upload successfully and success					Positive	

					2. Select test.txt		message
should be displayed.							

+	-----	+	-----	+	-----	+	-----	+
-----	+	-----	+	-----	+	-----	+	-----

	TC05		Upload valid DOCX file		test.docx, 4 MB		Upload area visible		1. Click
upload/select file			DOCX file should upload successfully and success					Positive	

					2. Select test.docx		message
should be displayed.							

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	TC06		Upload valid XLSX file		test.xlsx, 4 MB		Upload area visible		1. Click
upload/select file			XLSX file should upload successfully and success					Positive	

				2. Select test.xlsx	message
should be displayed.					

TC07	Upload valid HTM file	test.htm, 4 MB	Upload area visible	1. Click upload/select file	HTM file should upload successfully and success	Positive
------	-----------------------	----------------	---------------------	-----------------------------	---	----------

				2. Select test.htm	message
should be displayed.					

TC08	Verify maximum file size boundary	test.pdf, exactly	Upload area visible	1. Select file of exactly 5 MB	File of exactly 5 MB should be accepted and	Boundary
------	-----------------------------------	-------------------	---------------------	--------------------------------	---	----------

		5 MB		2. Start upload	success
message should be displayed.					

TC09	Verify file size greater than	test.pdf, 5.01 MB	Upload area visible	1. Select file greater than 5 MB	File should not be uploaded and an appropriate	Negative
------	-------------------------------	-------------------	---------------------	----------------------------------	--	----------

	allowed limit			2. Start upload	file-
size error message should be displayed.					

TC10	Verify compressed files are not	test.zip, 2 MB	Upload area visible	1. Select ZIP file	Compressed file should be rejected and an appropriate	Negative
------	---------------------------------	----------------	---------------------	--------------------	---	----------

	accepted			2. Start upload	
unsupported/compressed-file error should display.					

TC11	Verify unsupported file format	test.exe, 2 MB	Upload area visible	1. Select EXE file	Unsupported file format should be rejected and an	Negative
------	--------------------------------	----------------	---------------------	--------------------	---	----------

				2. Start upload	
appropriate format error should be displayed.					

TC12	Verify filename length boundary	55-character	Upload area visible	1.
Select supported file having	File with filename of exactly 55 characters should	Boundary		

	filename.pdf, 3 MB	55-character filename
be accepted if 55 is the maximum allowed length.		

		2. Start upload	Success
message should be displayed.			

TC13	Verify filename greater than	56-character	Upload area visible	1. Select
supported file having	File with filename greater than 55 characters should	Negative		

allowed length	filename.pdf, 3 MB	56-character filename
be rejected and filename-length error should display.		

		2. Start upload	

TC14	Verify special characters in	test@#\$_file!.pdf	Upload area visible	1.
Select supported file with	File should be accepted and uploaded successfully.	Positive		

filename are allowed	3 MB	special characters in
filename	Success message should be displayed and filename	

		2. Start upload	should be
handled/displayed correctly.			

TC15	Verify combined boundary and	test@#\$_file.pdf,	Upload area visible	1.
Select supported file	File should be rejected because its size is greater	Edge		

	validation conditions	5.01 MB, 56+ chars		2. Start upload
	than 5 MB and/or filename exceeds 55 characters.			
				3. Observe validation message
	Appropriate error message(s) should be displayed.			

```

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Coverage

Positive: TC01–TC07, TC14

Boundary: TC08, TC12

Negative: TC09–TC11, TC13

Edge: TC15

Mandatory formats covered: PDF, TIF, TXT, DOCX, XLSX, HTM

Maximum size: 5 MB

Compressed files: ZIP rejection

Unsupported format: EXE rejection

Filename limit: 55 characters

Special characters: Allowed

Upload success/error messages: Covered

Upload icon/area positioning: TC01

Note: I treated 5 MB and 55 characters as inclusive limits—so exactly 5 MB and exactly 55 characters should pass, while values above those limits should fail. This follows your stated requirement;

the live iLovePDF documentation itself currently shows different size limits for various tools, so these test cases should be treated as the requirements for the application under test rather than as claims about iLovePDF's current global limits.

| Observation | First Output

| Second Output

| What Improved & Why

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| ****1. Requirement coverage**** | Covered general file-upload scenarios, including security, browser compatibility, accessibility, and network failures. However, it did not specifically focus on all the requirements from the prompt. | Explicitly covers ****PDF, TIF, TXT, DOCX, XLSX, HTM****, 5 MB limit, compressed files, filename length, special characters, and upload messages. | ****Improved requirement traceability.**** The second output maps the test cases directly to the stated business requirements, making it easier for QA to verify complete coverage. |

| ****2. Boundary and negative testing**** | Included many useful negative and edge cases such as 0-byte files, corrupted files, oversized files, MIME spoofing, and long filenames. | Specifically tests ****exactly 5 MB vs. greater than 5 MB**** and ****exactly 55 vs. greater than 55 characters****, along with unsupported and compressed files. | ****Improved boundary testing.**** Explicit boundary values make the expected behavior unambiguous and help detect off-by-one validation defects. |

| ****3. Format and execution clarity**** | Provided 45 detailed scenarios, but the large scope could make it harder to execute against the specific requirement. | Reduced to exactly ****15 prioritized test cases**** and added a ****Type**** column for Positive, Negative, Boundary, and Edge cases. | ****Improved usability and focus.**** The second output follows the requested 15-case limit and gives testers a clear classification of each scenario, making execution and coverage review easier. |

3. Scenario Name : Scenario 6 — Mobile App (OTP Login)

Weak Prompt : "Test OTP login on mobile."

What I Feel is Missing:

1. Where it is Android or iPhone?
2. How many digits in the OTP like 4 or 6?
3. What is the OTP expiry time like 30 sec or 1 min?
4. Will it have resend OTP option?
5. When the network fails to connect will the OTP resend automatically with any error?
6. If user moved to different country then how the OTP works?

Rewritten Prompt

Persona: Act as Senior QA Engineer

Context: Use the WhatsApp login in iPhone using the OTP.

Instruction: Generate test case for WhatsApp login using the OTP.

[Critical] When the app installed it will ask the OTP for the registered mobile number.

Then OTP only accepts 6 digits with Resend OTP option.

[Mandatory] Include the OTP expiry time as 1 min and if user clicks the Resend OTP then it should send again or it will not.

[Essential] If user entered correct OTP but time expired then error message should display.

It user moved to different country then user should get a correct message.

It network connect to fails then user need to click Resend OTP button.

[Strict] Generate 7 test case to cover positive, negative, edge and boundary.

Example: Test ID | Description | Test Data | Pre-Condition | Steps | Expected Result

TC01 | Verify Search feature | Laptop | Amazon.in should login | 1. Login to Amazon.in | Login should successful

Output Format: Generate gherkin test cases.

Tone: It should be in simple and formal.

Weak prompt Output:

Test ID	Description	Test Data	Pre-Condition	Steps	Expected Result	Type
TC01	Verify OTP login screen is displayed	Registered mobile number	App is installed and user is logged out	1. Open mobile app 2. Enter registered mobile number 3. Tap Login/Continue	OTP verification screen should be displayed and OTP should be sent to the registered mobile number	Positive
TC02	Verify login with valid OTP	Valid 6-digit OTP	OTP has been received	1. Enter valid OTP 2. Tap Verify	User should be successfully logged in and redirected to the home screen	Positive
TC03	Verify login with invalid OTP	Incorrect 6-digit OTP	OTP verification screen is displayed	1. Enter incorrect OTP 2. Tap Verify	Login should fail and an appropriate error message should be displayed	Negative
TC04	Verify OTP with fewer digits	12345	OTP verification screen is displayed	1. Enter OTP with fewer than required digits 2. Tap Verify	OTP should not be accepted and validation message should be displayed	Negative
TC05	Verify OTP with more digits	1234567	OTP verification screen is displayed	1. Enter more than the allowed number of digits	Extra digits should not be accepted or the user should receive appropriate validation	Boundary
TC06	Verify expired OTP	Expired OTP	OTP has expired	1. Enter expired OTP 2. Tap Verify	Login should fail and an OTP expired message should be displayed	Negative

TC07	Verify resend OTP functionality	New OTP	OTP verification screen is displayed	1. Tap Resend OTP 2. Enter newly received OTP 3. Tap Verify	New OTP should be sent and should allow successful login	Positive
TC08	Verify old OTP after resend	Old OTP	New OTP has been generated	1. Request new OTP 2. Enter previous OTP 3. Tap Verify	Previous OTP should be invalid and login should fail	Negative
TC09	Verify OTP resend timer	Resend timer	OTP verification screen is displayed	1. Observe resend option 2. Wait until timer expires	Resend option should remain disabled during the configured period and become available afterward	Boundary
TC10	Verify OTP with blank input	Blank OTP	OTP verification screen is displayed	1. Leave OTP field blank 2. Tap Verify	Login should not proceed and required-field validation should be displayed	Negative
TC11	Verify OTP containing alphabets/special characters	12AB@#	OTP verification screen is displayed	1. Enter alphabets/special characters	Non-numeric characters should not be accepted if OTP is numeric	Negative
TC12	Verify OTP auto-read functionality	Valid OTP received through SMS	SMS permission/OTP auto-read is supported	1. Receive OTP SMS 2. Observe OTP field	OTP should be detected/auto-filled according to the app's supported behavior	Positive
TC13	Verify OTP login with no network	Valid OTP + no internet	OTP screen is displayed	1. Disable network 2. Enter OTP 3. Tap Verify	Login should fail gracefully with an appropriate network error message	Negative
TC14	Verify multiple incorrect OTP attempts	Multiple invalid OTPs	OTP verification screen is displayed	1. Enter incorrect OTP repeatedly	App should enforce configured attempt limits/security controls and display an appropriate message	Security
TC15	Verify successful login session	Valid OTP	Valid OTP is available	1. Enter valid OTP 2. Tap Verify 3. Close and reopen app	User should remain logged in according to the configured session policy	Positive

ICEPOT Output:

Feature: WhatsApp Login Using OTP on iPhone

Background:

Given WhatsApp is installed on an iPhone

And the user has a registered mobile number

And the user is on the WhatsApp OTP verification screen

Scenario: TC01 - Verify OTP is requested after WhatsApp installation

Given WhatsApp has been installed for the first time

When the user enters the registered mobile number

Then WhatsApp should send an OTP to the registered mobile number

And the OTP verification screen should be displayed

Scenario: TC02 - Verify login with a valid 6-digit OTP

Given a valid OTP has been sent to the registered mobile number

And the OTP is within the 1-minute validity period

When the user enters the correct 6-digit OTP

Then the user should be successfully logged in to WhatsApp

Scenario: TC03 - Verify OTP accepts only 6 digits

Given the OTP verification screen is displayed

When the user enters fewer or more than 6 digits

Then the OTP should not be accepted

And the user should be prompted to enter a valid 6-digit OTP

Scenario: TC04 - Verify OTP expiry after 1 minute

Given a valid 6-digit OTP has been received

When 1 minute has elapsed

And the user enters the correct OTP

Then the OTP should not be accepted

And an appropriate OTP expired error message should be displayed

And the user should be provided with an option to request a new OTP

Scenario: TC05 - Verify Resend OTP functionality

Given the OTP verification screen is displayed

And the Resend OTP option is available

When the user clicks "Resend OTP"

Then a new OTP should be sent to the registered mobile number

And the new OTP should be valid for 1 minute

And the user should be able to log in using the new OTP

Scenario: TC06 - Verify OTP when network connection fails

Given the OTP verification screen is displayed

And the network connection fails

When the user attempts to verify the OTP

Then the OTP verification should not be completed

And an appropriate network error message should be displayed

And the user should be instructed to click "Resend OTP" after the network connection is restored

Scenario: TC07 - Verify login when user moves to another country

Given the user has moved to a different country

And the user is using the registered mobile number

When the user requests an OTP

Then WhatsApp should handle the country/phone number correctly

And the user should receive an appropriate message if the registered number or country is not supported

And the user should not be incorrectly logged in

Observation	First OTP Output
Second OTP Output	
What Improved & Why	
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| ****1. Requirement-specific coverage**** | The first output provided 15 generic OTP-login test cases, including blank OTP, invalid OTP, auto-read, session handling, and multiple attempts. | The second output focuses specifically on the requested ****WhatsApp iPhone OTP flow****, including installation, registered number, 1-minute expiry, resend, network failure, and country change. | ****Improved specificity.**** The second output is better aligned with the exact business requirements instead of covering generic OTP functionality. |

| ****2. Boundary and expiry validation**** | Covered OTP length and expiry generally, but did not use the exact ****1-minute expiry requirement****. | Explicitly validates ****6-digit OTP**** and ****1-minute validity****, including the case where the correct OTP is entered after expiry. | ****Improved boundary coverage.**** Exact values make the test behavior measurable and help identify timing-related defects. |

| ****3. Format and readability**** | Used a traditional test-case table with columns such as Test ID, Description, Test Data, Steps, and Expected Result. | Uses ****Gherkin Given/When/Then**** scenarios with seven focused cases. |

| ****Improved execution clarity.**** Gherkin makes preconditions, actions, and expected behavior easy for QA, developers, and automation teams to understand and potentially automate. |